

area. This helps to localise the user experience.

Metaverse technology is the latest buzzword, and many organisations believe that it can disrupt their IT policies, customer experience and market reach. However, there is a concern that metaverse may be over-hyped and we may be overthinking about metaverse enabled solutions. While we cannot overlook this technology, understanding its industrial applications and popular use cases will help us comprehend its impact better.

Though metaverse is the talk of the town since the last two years, it is not a new concept. In 1992, Neal Stephenson's fictional work 'Snow Crash' talked of digital avatars in a parallel digital world, with whom humans could interact. This was perhaps the first time that something like the metaverse was envisioned.

In June 2021, the famed venture capitalist Matthew Ball released a nine-part series of essays titled 'The Metaverse Primer'. He defines metaverse as a "massively scaled and interoperable network of real-time rendered digital world."

Examples of how metaverse tech is being used

Metaverse technology has led to a number of industrial solutions, one of which is a banking solution named MetaFi (metaverse for financial services). Here, a personalised avatar interacts with customers for services like core banking, wealth and asset management, and retail banking. Recently, Tintera announced that it is developing a new-age Web3 solution called Metaverse Bank that offers fully-functional private and investment solutions for end users with immersive services.

In Japan, virtual games played over the network were very popular for a long time. These 'Manga' games later transformed into massively multiplayer

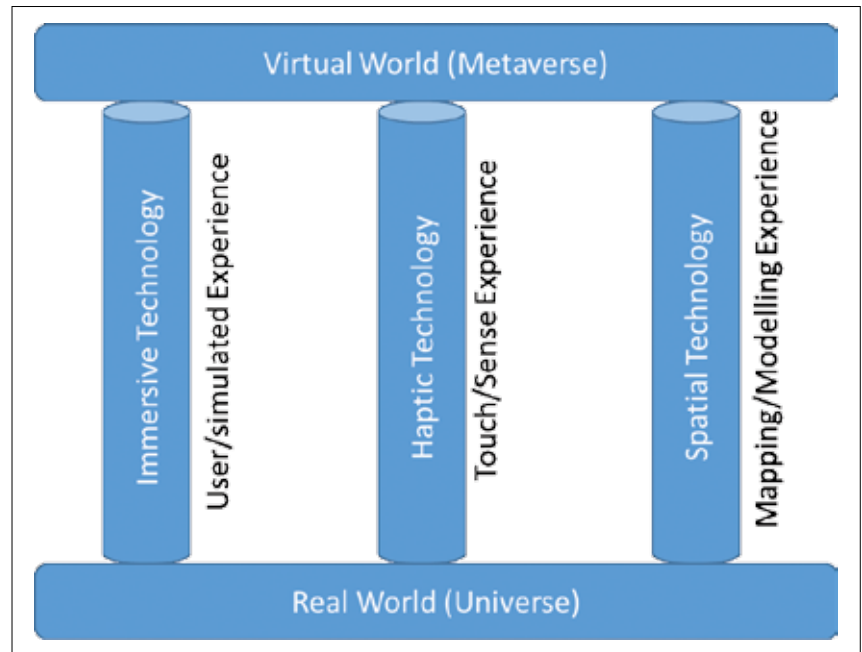


Figure 1: Pillars of metaverse

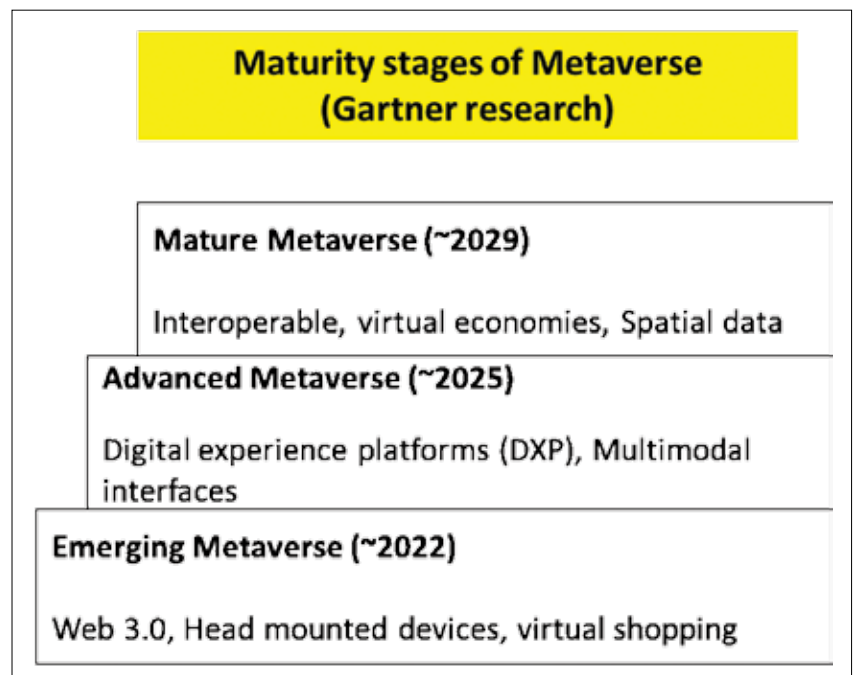


Figure 2: Maturity stages of the metaverse

online (MMO) interactive 3D games. The popularity of Microsoft's HoloLens and Mesh prove that there is a huge market for gaming.

Axie Infinity (AXS) and Smooth Love Potion (SLP) have converted crypto-tokens (earned from virtual

games) to ETH and then to USD. This is a new business model for earning through the digital world.

Tardiworld has hosted virtual marriage receptions, with friends and relatives attending from across the world. Gifts are being given as